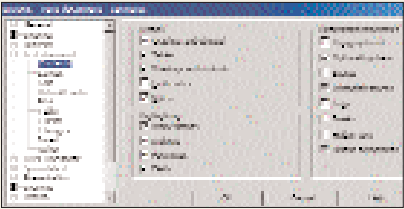


STAROFFICE

This free Office suite comes with StarOffice Writer—a word processor with some good features

☞ Enabling viewing graphics

If you embed graphics or images in your document, StarOffice Writer might show them as frames with the filename enclosed within. Don't worry, it could be



Enable viewing of pictures

that the option to view graphics is disabled by default to enable optimal loading of your document. (A document that's stuffed with graphics could take ages to load.) To enable the option, click on Tools > Options > Text Document > Contents. Enable the 'Pictures and Objects' option in the display section. Click OK to effect the changes... and presto, your pictures magically appear.

☞ Saving as PostScript

The advantage of a PostScript file is that it can be printed from any machine, even one that doesn't have StarOffice installed. To save a file as a PostScript file, click on File > Print. Enable the 'Print to File' option in the Print dialog box. Save the output to a file with a .PS extension. Now you can use the output file to print the document from any system with or without StarOffice.

☞ Maximising workspace

When StarOffice loads, it starts up in a window of its own and has all the elements confined within that space. Opening a Writer document within this would be even more difficult to view. To maximise the viewable area and to have a clear view of the document, use the Integrated Desk-

top option from the View menu or just press [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [I]. This overwrites the screen with only one visible window, thereby maximising the view space.

☞ Configuring toolbars

StarOffice Writer has a number of toolbars that it loads by default. Your desktop will be a big mess if you let this happen. It's better to have only those toolbars that you use often. You can do this by configuring your toolbars. To choose the toolbars that are to be loaded with StarOffice Writer, go to Tools > Configure. Choose the Toolbars tab and select the tools that you would require the most.

☞ Changing default paths

Most of the default settings can be changed. Ditto with file locations. This could prove useful if documents you work on are distributed over different locations. To change the default path for StarOffice documents, click through Tools > Options > General > Paths. Scroll down and select the Work folder. Click on the Edit button to change the default path and



Change the default settings to your liking

change it to a directory of your choice. Other folders could also be edited from the list that shows up.

☞ Removing page borders

In StarOffice Writer, the auto border is enabled by default, and it can be quite annoying. A document without a border is always preferable. To change the default settings, go to Tools > Autocorrect/



Uncheck the Apply Borders option

Autoformat. Under the Options tab, scroll down to the Apply Border Item option. Disable it and click OK to effect the changes. Now you don't have to be circumscribed by borders anymore.

☞ Spell-checking in different languages

Occasionally, you might want to check spellings for other languages compatible with StarOffice Writer. You can spell-check documents written in other languages just as easily as you would check the ones in English. Click on Tools > Options > General >

Spelling > Language. Activate All Languages under Check Spelling. Click OK to exit the dialog box. You can set the language for the text by selecting it and clicking on Format > Character > Font.

☞ Recording your job

If you do repetitive formatting or use the menu quite often for some purpose, you could record the sequence of operations with the Macro record option in Writer and execute the recorded code whenever you want to perform the same actions. For example, if you want to insert a picture (or a series of pictures), you could record the sequence of operations by clicking the record in the Tools > Macro submenu and save the macro with a specific name.

Ad will come